

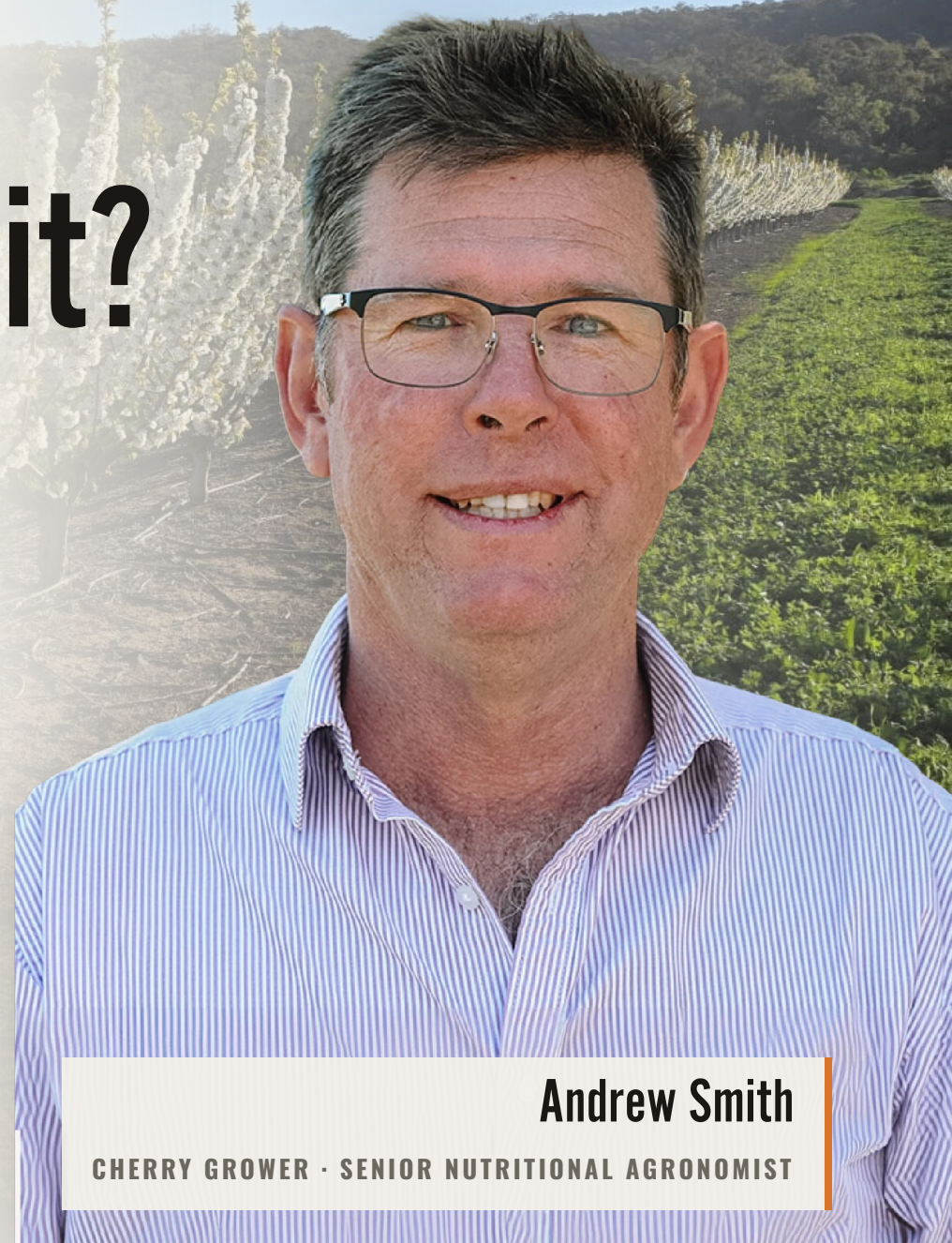
CELL DIVISION / CALCIUM

# How do I know Calcium is reaching the fruit?

Once the flowers are off, a cherry is building its cells. It doesn't get any more after this.

Calcium has to be there while it's happening.

Cherry block in flower, north-east Victoria, September 2026. Photo: Josh Richardson.



**Andrew Smith**

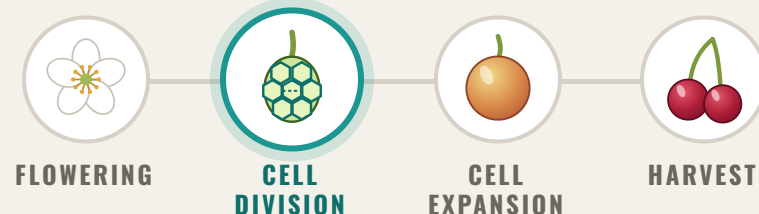
CHERRY GROWER · SENIOR NUTRITIONAL AGRONOMIST

## A good leaf test doesn't settle it.

The leaf and the fruit are fed differently.

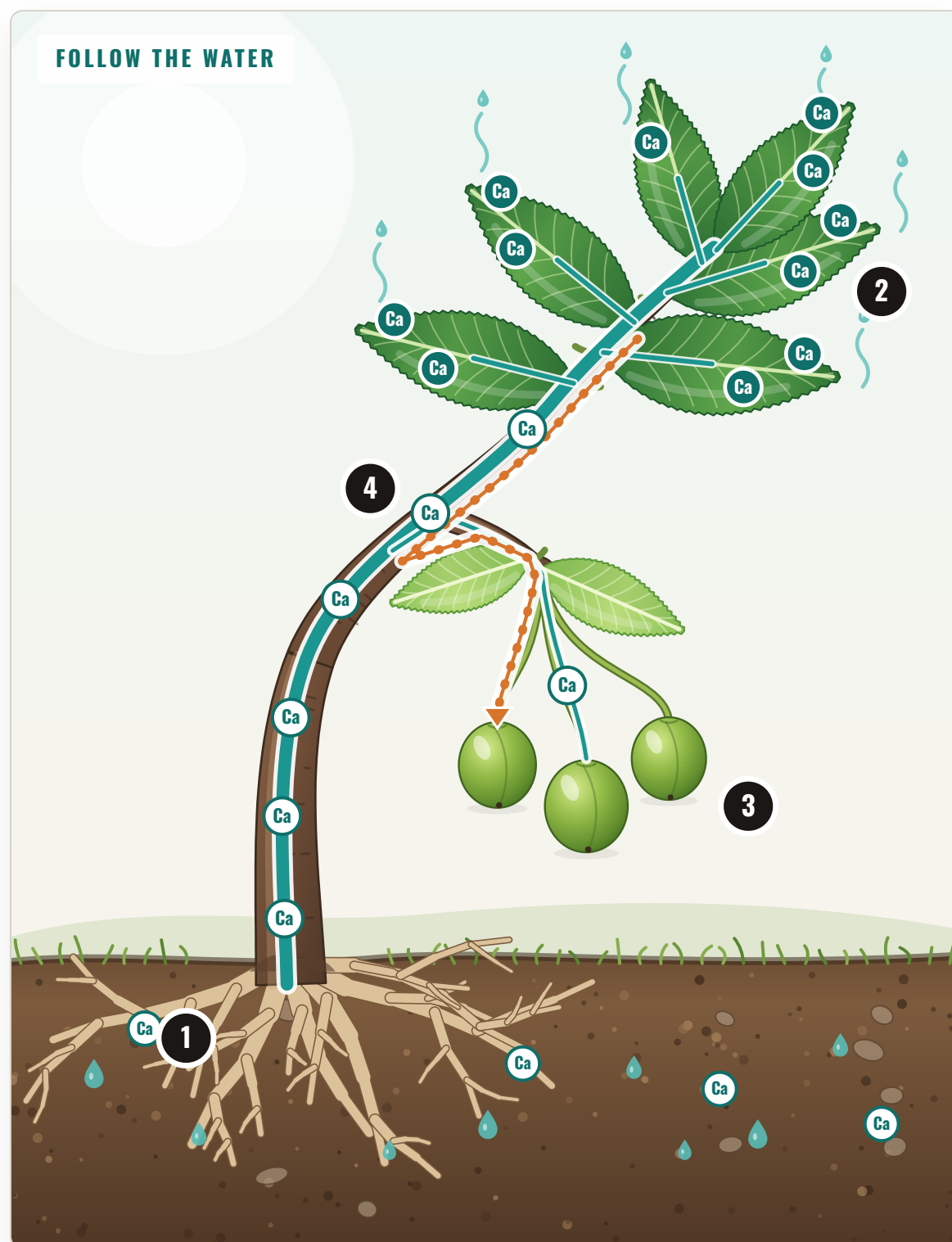
WHY THE LEAF ISN'T THE WHOLE ANSWER →

WHERE THIS SITS IN THE SEASON



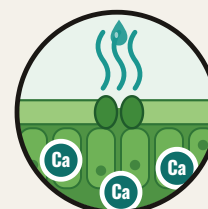
# Calcium in the leaf isn't Calcium in the cherry.

*Follow the water, and you can see why.*



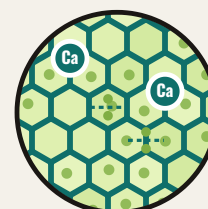
## 1 ROOTS

Water and Calcium come in together.



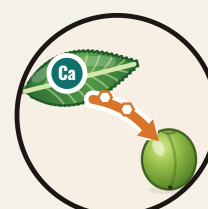
## 2 LEAVES

They pull most of the water, so most of the Calcium lands here.



## 3 YOUNG FRUIT

Draws far less water while its cell walls are being built.



## 4 SUGARS

Move on from leaf to fruit. Calcium largely stays behind.

So a leaf result tells you about the leaf. Whether the fruit gets its share comes down to water, roots and crop load as much as supply.

Drawn to explain the route. Leaf, bead and stream sizes are not measurements.

# Measure first. Then build the blend.

*How we tell a supply problem from a delivery problem.*

**01**

MEASURE

**A paired sap test, with the soil results.**

Sap from the youngest fully developed leaves and the oldest healthy leaves, read together. Then a look at the block: crop load, water, roots.

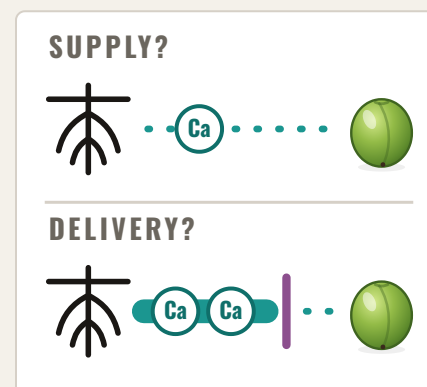


**02**

UNDERSTAND

**Is Calcium short, or not getting there?**

Water, root activity, crop load and shoot growth all change the answer. They are fixed differently.



**03**

INTERVENE

**A prescription blend for that block.**

Made to the results. Where a foliar Calcium fits, we use Power-Cal while the fruit tissue is forming.



**A leaf test isn't a fruit test.** It's one piece of evidence, and it's worth more read with the rest.

**YOUR BLOCK**

# Bring your soil and leaf results.

We'll walk through what your trees are telling you.

SOIL TESTS

LEAF TESTS

SAP TESTS



“Most of us have results sitting in a drawer. Dig them out.”

ANDREW SMITH · CHERRY GROWER · HYBRID-AG

Photo: Josh Richardson

SEND THEM THROUGH

**hybridag.com.au/contactus**

Soil, leaf or sap. Whatever you have.

OR CALL

**(03) 5722 7555**

Ask for the cherry team.

CHERRY GROWERS ONLINE

# An hour on cherries with Andrew Smith.

Bring a question from your own block.

DAY + DATE TO CONFIRM

7PM AEDT

ONLINE



“If you had to describe your crop in 30 seconds today, what would you say?”

ANDREW SMITH · CHERRY GROWER · HYBRID-AG

Photo: Josh Richardson

GET THE LINK

**hybridag.com.au/contactus**

Message us and we'll send it through.

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